

**BEFORE THE
FEDERAL MARITIME COMMISSION**

FRANCIS SHEKA KANU,

Complainant,

v.

EJIKE DICKSON EZE, SEALINES INTERNATIONAL,
SEAMATES INTERNATIONAL, INC., and MAERSK,

Respondents.

DOCKET NO. 25-05

FIRST JOINT STATUS REPORT

Pursuant to this Court’s Order, dated September 4, 2025 and 46 C.F.R. § 502.141(h), Complainant Francis Sheka Kanu (“Kanu” or “Complainant”) and Respondents Ejike Dickson Eze (“Ejike”), Sealines International, Seamates International, Inc. (together “SeaLines”), and Maersk (“Maersk”) (Ejike, SeaLines and Maersk collectively may be referred to as “Respondents”)(each of Complainant and Respondents may be referred to as a “Party” and collectively as the “Parties”), by their respective undersigned counsel, have conferred and submit this joint status report and proposed discovery schedule, as follows¹:

1. As requested by the Court, the Parties are able to provide the following information on the status of the re-export of Kanu's container from Pointe Noire, Congo to Freetown, Sierra Leone. It has been reported that the Kanu’s goods were removed from the container and the perishable cargo disposed of. Ejike is working with an agent in Pointe Noire to obtain

¹ This Joint Status Report was prepared by counsel for Respondents SeaLines International and SeaMates International, circulated among all the Parties and approved by Ejike and counsel for Maersk. However, Complainant, Kanu, has neither consented nor objected to this Joint Status Report. Kanu has not provided any response.

governmental release of the goods for re-export to Freetown. Once governmental authority is received, the remaining cargo consisting of, among other things, autos and household goods, will be loaded into another container (being provided by Maersk) and will be shipped to Freetown, Sierra Leone.

2. With respect to a possible resolution of this matter, although the Parties have not agreed upon a settlement, the Parties are considering a dismissal of this proceeding without prejudice to allow the Parties to continue to work toward the re-export of Kanu's container from Congo to its original destination in Freetown, Sierra Leone without the added cost of this proceeding.

3. Keeping within the 150-day time period set by 46 C.F.R. § 502.141(g), the Parties propose the following discovery schedule:

- October 3, 2025 Parties to exchange initial disclosures required by 46 C.F.R. § 502.141(b);
- October 31, 2025 Parties to serve requests for production of documents ("RFPs") and interrogatories and file Joint Status Report;
- December 5, 2025 Parties to serve objections and responses to RFPs and interrogatories
- January 2, 2026 Submission of any unresolved disputes concerning initial RFPs and interrogatories
- January 9, 2026 Parties file Joint Status Report.
- January 9, 2026 Parties complete depositions of fact witnesses.
- January 23, 2026 Disclosure of parties' initial expert reports, if any.
- February 6, 2026 Disclosure of parties' rebuttal expert reports, if any.
- February 17, 2026 Complete expert depositions.
- February 17, 2026 Close of discovery.

4. The Parties will endeavor to prevent any requests for additional time, but limited extensions may become necessary if, for example, issues arise relating to the collection and production of documents located abroad or in the custody of non-parties, or relating to the need for testimony from non-parties or individuals located abroad. The Parties will work to limit such extension requests, including by working to facilitate consent for e-mail service of subpoenas and provision of contact information, where available, but in the interest of full transparency, the Parties wish to note such possible issues for the Presiding Officer now.

5. In addition, given the Parties' ongoing attempts to resolve this matter, the Parties propose to file another Joint Status report with the Presiding Officer on October 31, 2025 and January 9, 2026 to report on the status of case to the Presiding Officer.

Dated: September 22, 2025

Respectfully submitted by,

FRANCIS SHEKA KANU Francis Sheka Kanu francesgats@gmail.com 6042 The Plaza Charlotte, NC 28215	EJIKE DICKSON EZE S/ Ejike Dickson Eze ejikeinternational89@gmail.com 1000 Montana Drive Charlotte, NC 28215
GEORGE W. WRIGHT & ASSOCIATES LLC S/ George W. Wright gwright@wright-associate.com Narinder S. Parmar nparmar@wright-associate.com 505 Main Street – Suite 106 Hackensack, NJ 07601 Counsel for Respondent Maersk	BETANCOURT GRECO & EVANS LLC S/ John Greco jgreco@bge-law.com 151 Bodman Place – Suite 200 Red Bank, NJ 07701 Telephone: 732-530-4646 Counsel for Respondents SeaLines International and SeaMates International, Inc.

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I certify, under penalty of perjury, that on this 22nd day of September, 2025 the foregoing Joint Status Report was served via electronic mail on:

Francis Sheka Kanu at:	francesgats@gmail.com
Ejike Dickson Eze at:	ejikeinternational89@gmail.com
George W. Wright at:	gwright@wright-associate.com
Narinder S. Parmar at:	nparmar@wright-associate.com

the addresses set forth in the Notices of Appearance and Answers on file with the Commission in this case.

_____/s/ John Greco

John Greco